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1 Capital

1.1 Chapter 13: Co-operation

The unique results of co-operation and the combination of labor. Specifically capitalist forms of co-operation, which differ from 'primitive' forms.

- Capitalist production *really* begins when production is extensive and a large number of workers are employed.
- (439) “A large number of workers working together, at the same time, in one place (or, if you like, in the same field of labour), in order to produce the same sort of commodity under the command of the same capitalist, constitutes the starting point of capitalist production. This is true both historically and conceptually.”

“At first, then, the difference is purely quantitative.”

- (443) “Not only do we have here an increase in the productive power of the individual, by means of co-operation, but the creation of a new productive power, which is intrinsically a collective one.”

(447) “This power arises from co-operation itself. When the worker co-operates in a planned way with others, he strips off the fetters of his individuality, and develops the capabilities of his species.”

- (448–9) “All directly social or communal labour on a large scale requires, to a greater or lesser degree, a directing authority.... A single violin player is his own conductor: an orchestra requires a separate one. The work of directing, superintending and adjusting becomes one of the functions of capital, from the moment that the labour under capital's control becomes co-operative. As a specific function of capital, the directing function requires its own special characteristics.”
- (449) “Moreover, the co-operation of wage-labourers is entirely brought about by the capital that employs them.”
- (452) “Co-operation in the labour process, such as we find it at the beginning of human civilization, among hunting peoples or, say, as a predominant feature of the agriculture of Indian communities, is based on the one hand on the common ownership of the conditions of production, and on the other hand on the fact that in those cases the individual has as little torn himself free from the umbilical cord of his tribe or community as a bee has from his hive. Both of these characteristics

distinguish this form of co-operation from capitalist co-operation. The sporadic application of co-operation on a large scale in ancient times, in the Middle Ages, and in modern colonies, rests on direct relations of domination and servitude, in most cases on slavery.”